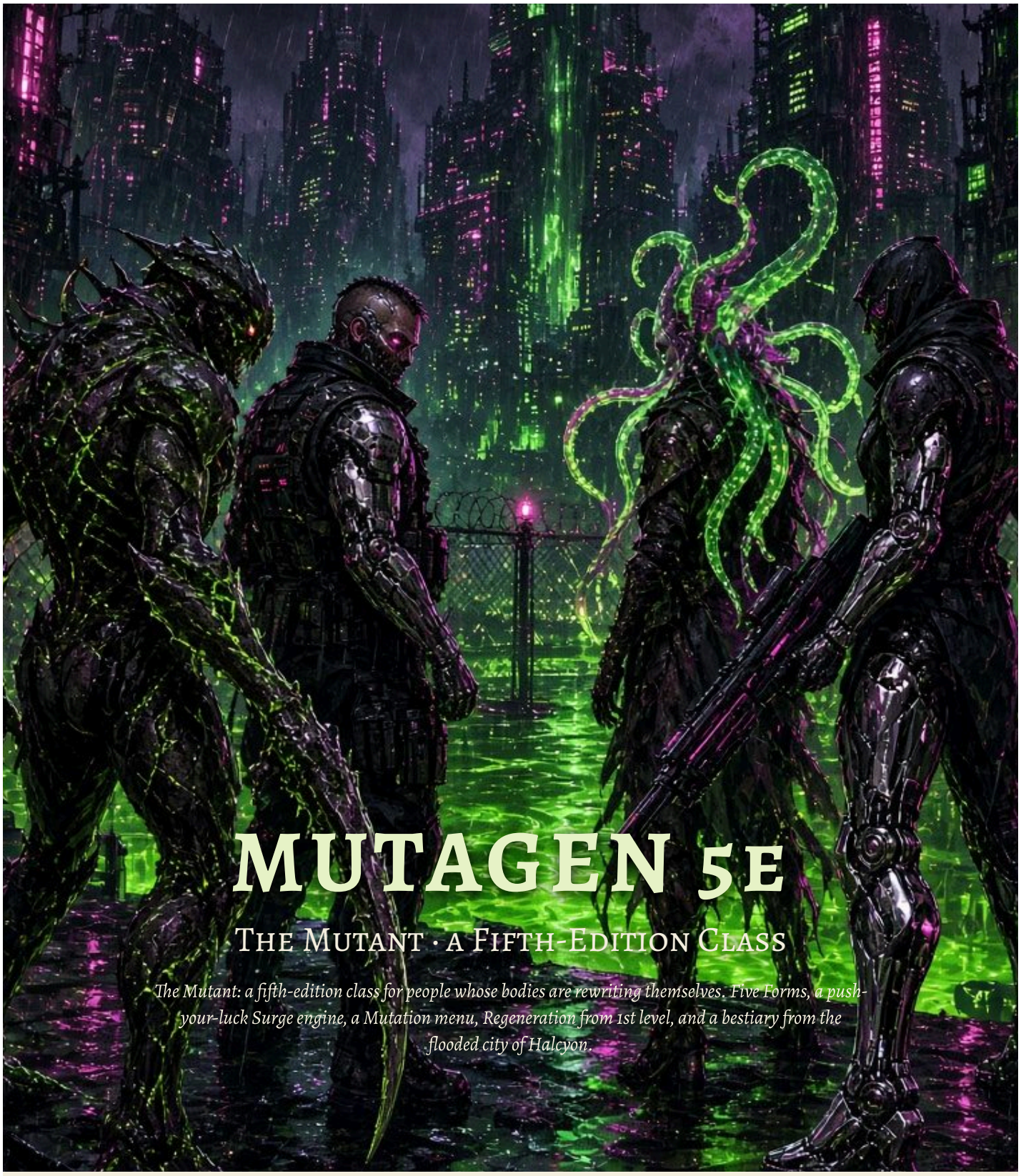


MUTAGEN 5e

The Mutant · a Fifth-Edition Class

The Mutant: a fifth-edition class for people whose bodies are rewriting themselves. Five Forms, a push-your-luck Surge engine, a Mutation menu, Regeneration from 1st level, and a bestiary from the flooded city of Halcyon.

What's in This Book

- **The Mutant** (class, levels 1–20) with five subclasses, the **Forms**: Juggernaut, Skitter, Oracle, Alembic and Siren.
- **Surge Parts**, the **Mutation Trees** and the **Overload** tables.
- **Options:** the GRAFT Freelancer background, five feats and Mutagen gear.
- **Bestiary:** twenty stat blocks, CR ½ to 23, including three Bosses with legendary actions.
- **Design Notes:** how the original *Mutagen* rules map to 5e, and the balance targets the class was tuned to.

You need the fifth-edition core rules; everything this book relies on is in the **System Reference Document 5.1**, a full copy of which ships alongside it (`5e/srd/`).

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The Mutant



The flood came up through the reactor district and left something in the water. Most people who drank it got sick. A few got different*. Their bones learned new shapes; their blood learned to burn, to heal, to sing. GRAFT pays them to go back into the Spill. They call themselves freelancers. Everyone else calls them Mutants.*

A Mutant's power is the **Mutagen**, a living compound that rewrites the body under stress. A Mutant doesn't cast spells. When danger comes, their body *prepares*: certain Surges come ready (they're **Primed**) and others take more effort. Every Surge raises the Mutant's **Flux**, the chemical pressure in their blood. Push Flux past its limit and the body **Overloads**: it Blooms (Bio) or Glitches (Chrome) in ways that are sometimes wonderful and sometimes horrible.

Designing a Mutant

- **Pick a Form** (the subclass) at 1st level: the shape your body is growing toward. **Juggernaut** (the wall), **Skitter** (the blur), **Oracle** (the eye), **Alembic** (the medic and alchemist), **Siren** (the voice).
- **Pick a Material: Bio** (flesh: heals better, Blooms), **Chrome** (implants: adaptable, Glitches) or **Splice** (both, at a cost).
- **Build two Surges** from a Shape and an Effect. A Mutant with a greatsword and a *Strike + Kinetic* Surge is a fine first character.

Creating a Mutant

Quick Build. Put your highest score in Constitution, then Strength or Dexterity (Wisdom for an Oracle, Intelligence for an Alembic, Charisma for a Siren). Choose the *GRAFT Freelancer* background (Options chapter).

Multiclassing. To multiclass into or out of the Mutant you need **Constitution 13**. Multiclassing into the Mutant gives you proficiency with light armor, simple weapons and one skill from the Mutant's list. The Mutant has no spell slots and adds nothing to your spellcaster level.

Class Features

As a Mutant, you gain the following class features.

Hit Points

- **Hit Dice:** 1d10 per Mutant level
- **Hit Points at 1st Level:** 10 + your Constitution modifier
- **Hit Points at Higher Levels:** 1d10 (or 6) + your Constitution modifier per Mutant level after 1st

Proficiencies

- **Armor:** Light armor, medium armor, shields
- **Weapons:** Simple weapons, martial weapons
- **Tools:** One type of artisan's tools or the herbalism kit
- **Saving Throws:** Constitution, Strength
- **Skills:** Choose two from Acrobatics, Athletics, Insight, Intimidation, Medicine, Nature, Perception, Stealth and Survival

Equipment

You start with the following equipment, in addition to the equipment granted by your background:

- (*a*) scale mail or (*b*) leather armor, a shortbow and 20 arrows
- (*a*) a martial weapon and a shield or (*b*) two martial weapons
- (*a*) a dungeoneer's pack or (*b*) an explorer's pack
- a GRAFT stim (heals 1d4 + 1 when drunk as an action; see Options)

The Mutant

Level	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Surge Dice	Surges Known	Flux Limit	Sequence Die	Prime	Mutations Known
1st	+2	Mutant Body, Surges, Flux, Regeneration, Material, Form	1d6	2	1	d4	1	—
2nd	+2	Mutations, Churn, Adaptations	1d6	2	1	d4	1	2
3rd	+2	Form feature, Deeper Sequence	1d6	3	2	d6	2	2
4th	+2	Ability Score Improvement	1d6	3	2	d6	2	3
5th	+3	Extra Attack, Surge Dice	2d6	4	3	d6	2	3
6th	+3	Evolution I (Form feature)	2d6	4	3	d8	3	3
7th	+3	Last Gasp	2d6	5	4	d8	3	4
8th	+3	Ability Score Improvement	2d6	5	4	d8	3	5
9th	+4	Improved Regeneration	2d6	6	5	d8	3	5
10th	+4	Form feature	2d6	6	5	d8	3	5
11th	+4	Saturated Strikes, Surge Dice	3d6	7	6	d8	3	5
12th	+4	Ability Score Improvement	3d6	7	6	d8	3	6
13th	+5	Adaptive Biology	3d6	8	7	d8	3	6
14th	+5	Evolution II (Form feature)	3d6	8	7	d12	4	6
15th	+5	Controlled Overload, Apex Mutations	3d6	9	8	d12	4	7
16th	+5	Ability Score Improvement	3d6	9	8	d12	4	8
17th	+6	Surge Dice	4d6	10	9	d12	4	8
18th	+6	Perfect Organism	4d6	10	9	d12	4	8
19th	+6	Ability Score Improvement	4d6	11	10	d12	4	9
20th	+6	Final Form	4d6	11	10	d12	4	9

Mutant Body

1st-level Mutant feature

Your body grows its own weapons: claws, spurs, bone blades, hydraulic pistons. Your unarmed strikes count as **natural weapons** that deal **1d8** slashing, piercing or bludgeoning damage (your choice each hit) on a hit. A natural weapon is a simple melee weapon with the finesse property; it can't be disarmed and doesn't need a free hand. Its damage die becomes **1d10 at 11th level**.

You can use a natural weapon, a martial weapon or any other weapon with your Surges.

Surges

1st-level Mutant feature

A **Surge** is a burst of mutation you build from parts, the way a chef builds a dish.

- A **Shape** says *how* the Surge reaches its target: a hit with a weapon, a bolt, a cone, a burst, a pulse around you, or a touch that changes an ally.
- An **Effect** says *what* it does: its damage type and its rider (push, burn, poison, blind and so on), or, for the Infuse Shape, the boon it gives.
- **Twists** (optional, chosen when you Unleash) modify it.

Surges Known. You know two Surges, each one Shape plus one Effect from the parts available to you (see *Surge Parts*). You learn more as shown in the Surges Known column. Name them; they're yours. When you gain a level in this class, you can rebuild one Surge you know.

Parts available. At 1st level you have the **base** parts (Strike, Bolt, Wave and Infuse Shapes; Kinetic and Snare Effects) plus the parts unlocked by the Root of your Form's primary tree. Each other tree's Root you take as a Mutation unlocks its parts too.

Surge Dice. Surge damage is measured in **Surge dice**, which are d6s, shown in the Surge Dice column: 1d6, 2d6 at 5th, 3d6 at 11th, 4d6 at 17th.

Surge Ability. Your Surge ability is **Constitution**, unless your Form says otherwise (Oracle: Wisdom; Alembic: Intelligence; Siren: Charisma).

- **Surge save DC** = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Surge ability modifier
- **Surge attack modifier** = your proficiency bonus + your Surge ability modifier

Unleashing. You can **Unleash** at most **one Surge per turn**. Unleashing it raises your Flux by **1, plus 1 for each Twist** you add (see *Flux*). The Shape says what action, if any, it takes.

The Sequence

1st-level Mutant feature

Write your Surges in a numbered list, your **Sequence**, with one numbered slot for each face of your **Sequence die** (d4 at 1st level; it grows as shown in the table). Put each Surge you know in a slot; slots left over are empty. Rearrange the list whenever you finish a long rest.

Priming. When you roll initiative, roll your Sequence die a number of times equal to your **Prime** number (1 at 1st level; see the table). Each Surge whose slot comes up is **Primed** for this combat:

- The **first** time you Unleash a Primed Surge in this combat, it costs **1 less Flux** (its basic cost of 1 becomes 0).
- If the same slot comes up twice, that Surge is **Amped**: its first Unleash costs **no Flux at all, even for its Twists**, and it rolls **one extra Surge die**.

- If the roll lands on an **empty** slot, your body improvises: roll on the **Wild Surge** table (after *Surge Parts*) and Unleash that result as a free action at the start of your first turn. It costs no Flux and counts as your Surge for that turn.

You can always Unleash a Surge that isn't Primed; it just costs its full Flux. The dice give you a bargain, never a lock-out.

Flux

1st-level Mutant feature

Flux measures how hard you're pushing your body. It starts at 0 and rises as you Unleash Surges. Your **Flux Limit** is shown in the table. When you finish a **short or long rest**, your Flux returns to 0.

Overload. You can Unleash a Surge that would take your Flux past your Limit. When you do, the Surge happens, and then you **Overload**:

1. You take necrotic damage equal to a number of d6s equal to your proficiency bonus. This damage can't reduce you below 1 hit point.
2. Roll a d12 on the **Bloom** table (Bio) or the **Glitch** table (Chrome).
3. Your Flux returns to 0.

You can't Overload more than once per turn. A creature who Overloads while at 1 hit point or fewer suffers no further damage from it.

Settle. Between fights your blood cools a little even without a rest. When you roll initiative, if your Flux is higher than half your Flux Limit (rounded up), it drops to that number.

Reading Flux at the Table

A 1st-level Mutant has a Flux Limit of 1 and Primes once per fight, so between rests (two fights) they can Unleash about **three Surges** before Overloading: two Primed ones for free and one paid. By 11th level (Flux Limit 6, Prime 3) they can Surge almost every turn and add Twists. Track Flux with a d20 or tally marks next to your Sequence. Overloading once in a hard fight is normal; that's the point.

Regeneration

1st-level Mutant feature

Your cells knit faster than anyone's should, and you can share that. As a **bonus action**, touch yourself or a willing creature and choose one:

- The creature regains hit points equal to **1d8 + your Surge ability modifier** (minimum 1).
- You end the **poisoned** condition or one **disease** affecting the creature.

If the creature had at least 1 hit point when you touched it, it also gains temporary hit points equal to your Surge ability modifier: your tissue is better at keeping someone up than at dragging them back.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your **proficiency bonus**, and regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest. It has no effect on undead or constructs.

The healing grows as you level: **2d8** at 5th level, **3d8** at 9th, **4d8** at 13th and **5d8** at 17th.

Regeneration vs. Healing Spells

Cure Wounds heals 1d8 + modifier as an action; *Healing Word* heals 1d4 + modifier as a bonus action at range. Regeneration heals like *Cure Wounds* with *Healing Word*'s action cost, but only by touch, and its uses (2 at 1st level) match a 1st-level Cleric's, Bard's or Druid's two spell slots. Its dice rise in step with a support caster upcasting *Cure Wounds* into their best slot. Over a day it heals more than a Paladin's *Lay on Hands* (15 vs 5 at 1st level, 65 vs 25 at 5th) and less than a Bard who spends every slot on *Healing Word* or a Druid on *Cure Wounds* (see *Design Notes*).

Material

1st-level Mutant feature

Your body takes the Mutagen in one of three ways. Choose one.

Bio. You're flesh all the way down.

- **Knit.** When you regain hit points from Regeneration or by spending Hit Dice, you regain extra hit points equal to your proficiency bonus.
- When you Overload, you roll on the **Bloom** table.

Chrome. Your mutations grow around implants and hardware.

- **Firmware.** When you finish a short rest, you can rebuild one Surge you know or swap one Mutation you know for another you qualify for.
- **Sealed Systems.** You have advantage on saving throws against poison and disease.
- When you Overload, you roll on the **Glitch** table.
- **Upkeep.** Chrome needs care: if you go a week without 1 gp of parts and an hour of maintenance, you lose Firmware until you do.

Splice. You're both.

- You gain **Knit** and **Firmware**.
- Your Flux Limit is **1 lower** than the table shows (minimum 1).
- When you Overload, choose the Bloom or Glitch table before you roll.



Form

1st-level Mutant feature

Choose the **Form** your body is growing toward: Juggernaut, Skitter, Oracle, Alembic or Siren, each detailed at the end of the class description. Your choice grants you features at 1st level and again at 3rd, 6th (Evolution I), 10th and 14th (Evolution II) level.

Each Form has a **primary Mutation tree**. You gain that tree's **Root** for free at 1st level (it doesn't count against your Mutations Known), and only your primary tree's Apex Mutation is open to you at 15th level.

Mutations

2nd-level Mutant feature

Your body has started growing extra features. You learn **two Mutations** of your choice from the *Mutation Trees* section. You learn more as shown in the Mutations Known column.

Each tree has a **Root**, **Tier I** Mutations, **Tier II** Mutations and an **Apex**.

- **Root:** learn this before any other Mutation of its tree. Your primary tree's Root is free. Each Root also unlocks the Surge parts listed with it.
- **Tier I:** needs the tree's Root.
- **Tier II:** needs 6th level, the Root, and two other Mutations of that tree.
- **Apex:** needs 15th level, your **primary** tree, the Root and four other Mutations of that tree.
- **Body** Mutations (the open list) have no Root; some need a level.

When you gain a level in this class or finish a long rest, you can replace one Mutation you know with another you qualify for (your body reshapes overnight). A Mutation that another depends on can't be replaced until the dependent one is.

Push. Some Mutations have a **Push** option. You can use it by raising your Flux by 1 (this can make you Overload). You can Push each Mutation only once per turn.

Churn

2nd-level Mutant feature

As a **bonus action** on your turn in combat, you can force your body to reshuffle: raise your Flux by 1 and roll your Sequence die once. The Surge in that slot is Primed (or Amped, if it already was Primed and its discount is unused). An empty slot gives you a Wild Surge as normal, which you can Unleash immediately as part of this bonus action.

Adaptations

2nd-level Mutant feature

Your body solves problems a spell would. When you finish a short or long rest, you can grow one **Adaptation** from the list below; it lasts until you grow a different one. You can maintain two Adaptations from 6th level and three from 14th. Growing one takes 10 minutes of visible, uncomfortable change (Chrome: printing and fitting a part).

Adaptation	Effect
Gill Slits	You can breathe water and have a swimming speed equal to your walking speed.
Sticky Pads	You have a climbing speed equal to your walking speed.
Night Eyes	You have darkvision out to 60 ft (or +30 ft).
Bloodhound	You have advantage on Wisdom (Perception) and Wisdom (Survival) checks that rely on smell, and you can track by scent.
Chromatophores	You can change your skin's colour and texture; you have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide while you don't move.
Polyglot Gland	You understand one spoken language of your choice that you've heard in the last day (you can't speak it).
Pressure Lung	You can hold your breath for 1 hour and are immune to inhaled poisons and gases.
Long Bones	Your reach for grapples and for interacting with objects is 10 ft, and your jump distances are doubled.
Pliant Frame	You can squeeze through a space as narrow as 6 inches and have advantage on checks to escape a grapple or restraints.
Echo Skull	You have blindsight out to 10 ft.
Fever Glands	You're comfortable in extreme heat or cold and have resistance to fire or cold damage (choose when you grow it).
Mimic Throat	You can mimic any voice or sound you've heard; a listener sees through it with a successful Wisdom (Insight) check against your Surge save DC.

Deeper Sequence

3rd-level Mutant feature

Your body's repertoire widens. Your Sequence die becomes a **d6** (two more slots), your **Prime** rises to 2, and you gain proficiency in one skill from the Mutant's list. Additionally, you regain one expended use of Regeneration when you finish a short rest.

Ability Score Improvement

4th-level Mutant feature

When you reach 4th level, and again at 8th, 12th, 16th and 19th level, you can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or you can increase two ability scores of your choice by 1. As normal, you can't increase an ability score above 20 using this feature. If your game uses feats, you can take a feat instead.

Extra Attack

5th-level Mutant feature

You can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the Attack action on your turn. A **Bolt** Surge can replace one of these attacks, and so can a use of **Regeneration** (so healing an ally doesn't cost you your bonus action).

Evolution I

6th-level Mutant feature

The Mutagen finishes its first rewrite of you. Your appearance changes (see your Form's *Looks* table), and:

- Your **Prime** rises to 3 and your **Sequence die** becomes a **d8**.
- **Signature Surge.** Choose one Surge you know as your Signature. It carries one Twist of your choice for free, every time (choose the Twist when you choose the Signature). Being Primed doesn't change that.
- **Emergence.** When you roll initiative, or as a bonus action, you can show what you've become. You gain temporary hit points equal to your Mutant level + your Surge ability modifier, each creature of your choice within 30 feet that can see you must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw against your Surge save DC or be frightened of you until the end of your next turn, and your Signature Surge becomes Amped if it wasn't already. Once you use Emergence, you can't do so again until you finish a long rest.
- **Instinct.** Once per long rest, when you roll your Sequence die to Prime, you can choose the result instead of rolling.
- You gain your Form's **Evolution I** feature.

Last Gasp

7th-level Mutant feature

When you are reduced to 0 hit points but not killed outright, you can drop to 1 hit point instead and **Overload** (roll on your Bloom or Glitch table and set your Flux to 0, but take no Overload damage). Once you use this feature, you can't use it again until you finish a long rest.

Improved Regeneration

9th-level Mutant feature

Your Regeneration can now reach a creature you can see within **30 feet** (a spray of tissue, a stim dart, a nanite cloud), and you can use it one additional time per long rest (proficiency bonus + 1).

Saturated Strikes

11th-level Mutant feature

The Mutagen bleeds into every blow. Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, it takes an extra **1d6** damage of the type of any damaging Effect you know. This doesn't count as Unleashing a Surge and costs no Flux.

Adaptive Biology

13th-level Mutant feature

When you finish a long rest, choose acid, cold, fire, lightning, necrotic, poison or thunder. You have resistance to that damage type until you finish your next long rest. Additionally, you're immune to disease.

Evolution II

14th-level Mutant feature

Your second rewrite. Your appearance changes again, and:

- Your **Prime** rises to 4 and your **Sequence die** becomes a **d12**.
- Choose a second **Signature Surge** (it carries one free Twist, as above).
- You regain your use of **Emergence** whenever you roll initiative and have no uses left, once per long rest.
- From now on, any Surge can carry **two** Twists.
- You gain your Form's **Evolution II** feature.

Before 14th level, a Surge can carry only one Twist (a Signature's free Twist plus one paid Twist counts as two, and is allowed at 6th level).

Controlled Overload

15th-level Mutant feature

You've learned to ride the edge. When you Overload, you take half the usual damage, and you roll the d12 twice and choose which result applies. Your primary tree's **Apex** Mutation becomes available to you.

Perfect Organism

18th-level Mutant feature

You're immune to the poisoned condition and poison damage, and you no longer age. At the start of each of your turns, if you have at least 1 hit point and no more than half your hit point maximum, you regain hit points equal to 5 + your Constitution modifier.

Final Form

20th-level Mutant feature

You become what the Mutagen always wanted. Your Constitution score and your Strength or Dexterity score (your choice) each increase by 2, and your maximum for those scores is now 22.

As a bonus action, you can unleash your **Final Form** for 1 minute. For the duration:

- Unleashing a Surge raises your Flux by **0** (Twists included), and you can Unleash **two** Surges per turn.
- Your speed increases by 10 feet and you have resistance to bludgeoning, piercing and slashing damage.
- You gain your Form's **finale** (see each Form).

The transformation ends early if you're incapacitated or you end it (no action). Once you use Final Form, you can't do so again until you finish a long rest.

Surge Parts

A Surge is **one Shape + one Effect**. Damaging Effects pair with Strike, Bolt, Wave, Burst and Pulse; Infuse Effects pair only with Infuse. *Source* says where a part comes from: **base** parts are known by every Mutant; the rest are unlocked by a tree's Root Mutation (your Form's primary Root is free).

Shapes

Shape	Source	Action	Delivery
Strike	base	none (part of a hit)	When you hit a creature with a weapon attack, Unleash: the target takes **Surge dice** extra damage of the Effect's type and suffers its rider
Bolt	base	one attack of the Attack action, or an action	Ranged Surge attack, range 60 ft: **Surge dice + Surge ability modifier** damage and the rider
Wave	base	action	15-ft cone. Each creature in it makes a saving throw (Dexterity, or the Effect's listed save): on a failure **Surge dice + 1 Surge die** damage and the rider; on a success half damage and no rider
Burst	Glands	action	10-ft-radius sphere centred on a point within 60 ft; save as Wave
Pulse	Hide	action	Each creature of your choice within 10 ft of you; Constitution save instead of Dexterity, otherwise as Wave
Infuse	base	bonus action	You or a creature you can see within 30 ft gains the Infuse Effect

Damaging Effects

A rider that calls for a saving throw uses your Surge save DC; for Wave, Burst and Pulse the same failed save applies the damage and the rider (no second save). Riders last until the **start of your next turn** unless stated otherwise.

Effect	Source	Damage	Rider
Kinetic	base	force	Push the target up to 10 ft away from you (Large or smaller)
Snare	base	bludgeoning	Strength save or **restrained** (escape: action, Strength (Athletics) check vs your Surge save DC)
Shock	Wiring	lightning	The target can't take reactions
Blaze	Wiring	fire	At the start of its next turn the target takes fire damage equal to your Surge ability modifier; flammable objects ignite
Toxin	Glands	poison	Constitution save or **poisoned**
Corrode	Glands	acid	The next attack roll against the target before the start of your next turn has advantage
Quake	Hide	thunder	Strength save or knocked **prone** (Huge or smaller)
Glare	Senses	radiant	Constitution save or **blinded**
Dread	Mind	psychic	Wisdom save or **frightened** of you

Infuse Effects

Effect	Source	Boon
Mend	Glands	The target can spend one of its unspent Hit Dice: it regains hit points equal to the roll + its Constitution modifier + your Surge ability modifier. A creature with no Hit Dice left regains only your Surge ability modifier
Shell	Hide	The target gains **Surge dice + Surge ability modifier** temporary hit points and +1 AC until the start of your next turn
Haste	Wiring	Another creature (not you) can immediately use its reaction to move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks and make one weapon attack
Veil	Senses	The target is **invisible** until the start of your next turn, or until it attacks or casts a spell
Link	Mind	The target and up to your Surge ability modifier other creatures within 30 ft of it can each add **1d4** to their next attack roll or saving throw before the start of your next turn

Twists

Each Twist adds **1 Flux** to the Surge's cost. A Surge can carry one Twist (two from 14th level). A Twist that doesn't fit the Shape has no effect.

Twist	Effect
Overcharge	The Surge deals **1 extra Surge die** of damage (Shell: 1 extra die of temporary hit points; Mend: the target can spend 1 more Hit Die)
Chain	Strike or Bolt: a second creature within 15 ft of the target takes half the Surge's damage and suffers the rider (it saves separately if the rider allows one)
Reach	Double the Surge's range, or its area's size (15-ft cone → 30-ft; 10-ft radius → 20-ft). Infuse reaches 60 ft
Linger	Wave, Burst or Pulse: the area stays until the start of your next turn. A creature that enters it or starts its turn there takes damage equal to your Surge ability modifier and must save against the rider
Leech	You regain hit points equal to half the Surge damage dealt to one creature
Sure	One target has disadvantage on its save against the Surge, or the Bolt's attack roll has advantage, or Infuse affects a second creature in range
Hush	The Surge makes no light or sound and has no visible source; it doesn't reveal your position if you're hidden

Building Surges: Examples

Name	Build	Flux	Use
Mantis Lunge	Strike + Kinetic	1	Hit it hard and knock it back
Pin	Strike + Snare	1	Stop a runner
Acid Spit	Bolt + Corrode	1	Open a target up for the party
Arc Lash	Wave + Shock	1	Stop a hallway of reactions
Firebloom	Burst + Blaze + Linger	2	A burning zone
Stomp	Pulse + Quake	1	Everything around you falls down
Nightmare	Bolt + Dread	1	The Siren's go-to
Flashbulb	Burst + Glare	1	Blind the firing squad
Field Dressing	Infuse + Mend	1	Pairs with Regeneration
Carapace Flex	Infuse + Shell	1	Brace for impact
Overdrive Shot	Infuse + Haste	1	Give the sniper another shot
Vampire Bite	Strike + Toxin + Leech	2	Drink their strength
Hive Whisper	Infuse + Link + Sure	2	Everyone's luckier

Surges Outside Combat

In a tense scene the GM runs in rounds (a chase, a heist gone loud), Surges work as in combat. In calm scenes you can still Unleash a Surge for its obvious effect (Blaze lights a fire, Kinetic shoves a crate, Veil hides a lookout), but nothing is Primed, so it costs full Flux, and Flux only clears on a rest.

Wild Surge

When a Prime or Churn roll lands on an empty slot, roll a d12. A Wild Surge costs no Flux. Damage uses your Surge dice; saves use your Surge save DC.

d12	Wild Surge
1	**Misfire.** Nothing happens, but you can Churn once immediately without raising your Flux or using an action.
2	**Spore Bloom.** Burst + Toxin with 2 extra Surge dice, centred on you (you're unaffected; allies in it make the save too).
3	**Arc Storm.** Bolt + Shock against up to three creatures (one attack roll each). You can't take reactions until the start of your next turn.
4	**Hardening.** Shell on you and every ally within 10 ft of you. Your speed is 0 until the end of your next turn.
5	**Blood Price.** Your next weapon hit this turn deals Strike + Kinetic with 2 extra Surge dice. You take necrotic damage equal to a number of d6s equal to your proficiency bonus.
6	**Echo.** Unleash a copy of any Surge an ally you can see knows (if they're not a Mutant, roll again).
7	**Mitosis.** A shuddering copy of you appears in an unoccupied space within 5 ft. It has AC 10, 1 hit point and your speed; on your turn it can move and make one weapon attack using your bonuses. It melts after 1 minute.
8	**Phase Step.** Teleport up to 60 ft to a space you can see, then make one weapon attack with Strike + Kinetic (no Flux).
9	**Gravity Knot.** Burst with both the Quake and Snare riders.
10	**Feedback.** Pulse + Dread with a 20-ft radius; you take psychic damage equal to your proficiency bonus.
11	**Flush.** Your Flux returns to 0 and you regain hit points equal to a number of d8s equal to your proficiency bonus.
12	**Perfect Expression.** Two Surges of your choice become Amped for this combat.

Mutation Trees

Five trees and one open list. A Mutation's **prerequisites** are in its tier heading; extra ones are listed with it. Mutations marked **Push** have an option that costs 1 Flux (see *Mutations*).

Tree	Theme	Root unlocks	Primary for
Hide	Armour, toughness, protection	Pulse, Quake, Shell	Juggernaut
Wiring	Speed, reflexes, electricity	Shock, Blaze, Haste	Skitter
Senses	Perception, precision, range	Glare, Veil	Oracle
Glands	Chemistry, healing, poison	Burst, Toxin, Corrode, Mend	Alembic
Mind	Will, telepathy, presence	Dread, Link	Siren
Body	Limbs and anatomy (open list)	—	everyone

Hide

Root: Plating. Bony plates or armour weave grow over you. While you aren't wearing heavy armor, you gain a +1 bonus to AC. *Unlocks Pulse, Quake and Shell.*

Tier I *(prerequisite: Plating)*

- **Thick.** Your hit point maximum increases by your Mutant level, and again by 1 each time you gain a Mutant level.
- **Barbs.** When a creature within 5 ft of you hits you with a melee attack, it takes piercing damage equal to your proficiency bonus.
- **Anchor.** You have advantage on saving throws and ability checks against being moved, grappled or knocked prone. **Push:** as a reaction when a creature tries to move you or knock you prone, you automatically succeed.
- **Shoulder Check.** When you take the Attack action, you can replace one attack with a shove, and you can make a shove as a bonus action once per turn after you hit a creature with a melee weapon attack.

Tier II *(prerequisites: 6th level, Plating and two other Hide Mutations)*

- **Adaptive Hide.** When you take acid, cold, fire, lightning or thunder damage, you can use your reaction to gain resistance to that damage type, including against the triggering damage, until the end of your next turn. **Push:** the resistance lasts 1 minute.
- **Guardian.** When a creature you can see attacks a target other than you within 5 ft of you, you can use your reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll.
- **Menace.** As a bonus action, one creature within 30 ft that can see or hear you must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or have disadvantage on attack rolls against creatures other than you until the start of your next turn. You can do this a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest. **Push:** use it without expending a use.
- **Living Wall.** While you aren't incapacitated, allies within 5 ft of you gain a +1 bonus to AC.

Apex *(prerequisites: 15th level, Hide primary, Plating and four other Hide Mutations)*

- **Unbreakable.** When a creature you can see hits you with an attack, you can use your reaction to halve the attack's damage. Additionally, your Plating bonus becomes +2. **Push:** when you take damage that isn't from an attack, use your reaction to halve it.

Wiring

Root: Quickened. Wire threads your nerves. Your walking speed increases by 10 ft, and you can take the Dash action as a bonus action. *Unlocks Shock, Blaze and Haste.*

Tier I *(prerequisite: Quickened)*

- **Capacitor.** Once per turn when you hit a creature with a melee weapon attack, it takes an extra 1d4 lightning damage. **Push:** it can't take reactions until the start of its next turn.
- **Slipstream.** Opportunity attacks against you have disadvantage, and you can move through hostile creatures' spaces (treating them as difficult terrain).
- **Wall Run.** You gain a climbing speed equal to your walking speed, and you can move across vertical surfaces and liquids during your move without falling.
- **Twitch Reflexes.** You add your proficiency bonus to initiative rolls. **Push:** when you roll initiative, roll your Sequence die one extra time.

Tier II *(prerequisites: 6th level, Quickened and two other Wiring Mutations)*

- **Overclock.** On your turn, you can take one additional action. Once you use this, you can't again until you finish a long rest. **Push:** use it again before resting (once, then not again until a long rest).
- **Arc Jump.** As a bonus action, you teleport up to 20 ft to an unoccupied space you can see. **Push:** each creature in a 5-ft line between your old and new space takes lightning damage equal to your proficiency bonus.
- **Kinetic Battery.** When a creature misses you with an attack or you succeed on a Dexterity save, you gain a charge (maximum 3; charges vanish after 1 minute). When you hit with a weapon attack, spend any number of charges: the target takes 1d6 lightning damage per charge.
- **Afterimage.** When you take the Dash action, attack rolls against you have disadvantage until the start of your next turn.

Apex *(prerequisites: 15th level, Wiring primary, Quickened and four other Wiring Mutations)*

- **Blur.** Your walking speed is doubled. If you've moved at least 20 ft on your turn, attack rolls against you have disadvantage until the start of your next turn. **Push:** when you'd be hit by an attack, use your reaction to move up to half your speed; if you leave the attacker's reach or range, the attack misses.

Senses

Root: Keen. New eyes and pits along your face. You gain darkvision out to 60 ft (or +30 ft if you already have it), you have advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight or hearing, and you can't be blinded by bright light. *Unlocks Glare and Veil.*

Tier I *(prerequisite: Keen)*

- **Target Lock.** As a bonus action, or as part of hitting a creature with an attack, raise your Flux by 1 and mark a creature you can see within 120 ft for 1 minute (concentration, as if concentrating on a spell). Once per turn when you hit it with an attack, it takes an extra 1d6 damage of the weapon's type, and you always know its location while it's within 120 ft. (The Oracle's version, if you have it, replaces this.)
- **Threat Sense.** You can't be surprised while you're conscious. **Push:** when a creature you can see within 30 ft makes a saving throw, use your reaction to add your Wisdom modifier (minimum +1) to it.
- **Analyzer.** As a bonus action, choose a creature you can see within 60 ft. You learn its AC, its current hit points, and its damage resistances, immunities and vulnerabilities.
- **Echolocation.** You have blindsight out to 10 ft (30 ft from 11th level).

Tier II *(prerequisites: 6th level, Keen and two other Senses Mutations)*

- **Long Sight.** Your ranged weapon attacks and Bolt Surges ignore half cover and three-quarters cover, and attacking at long range doesn't impose disadvantage on your ranged weapon attack rolls.
- **Spotter.** As a bonus action, choose an ally within 60 ft and a creature you can see. The ally's next attack roll against that creature before the start of your next turn has advantage. You can do this a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest. **Push:** use it without expending a use.
- **Hair Trigger.** When you roll initiative, you can make one ranged weapon attack or Bolt (the Bolt uses its normal Flux) as a reaction, before anyone takes a turn.
- **Weak Spot.** Once per turn when you hit a creature you've Analyzed or Target Locked, the attack ignores its resistance to the damage.

Apex *(prerequisites: 15th level, Senses primary, Keen and four other Senses Mutations)*

- **Deadeye.** Your weapon attacks and Bolt Surges score a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20. **Push:** once per turn, reroll a missed attack roll.

Glands

Root: Spit. Glands in your throat and wrists. You have a natural ranged attack (range 30/60 ft) that deals 1d8 acid or poison damage; use Dexterity or your Surge ability modifier for its attack and damage rolls. You have resistance to poison damage. *Unlocks Burst, Toxin, Corrode and Mend.*

Tier I *(prerequisite: Spit)*

- **Antibodies.** You're immune to the poisoned condition and to disease, and your Regeneration can end the blinded or deafened condition as well.
- **Stim Reserve.** You can use Regeneration a number of additional times equal to your Surge ability modifier (minimum 1) per long rest.
- **Adrenal Dump.** The first time each combat you drop to half your hit points or fewer, you gain temporary hit points equal to your Mutant level + your Surge ability modifier, and your next attack roll has advantage.
- **Pheromones.** As an action, you emit a scent: each beast within 30 ft must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or be charmed by you for 1 minute (repeat the save if harmed). You also have advantage on Wisdom (Animal Handling) checks.

Tier II *(prerequisites: 6th level, Spit and two other Glands Mutations)*

- **Regenerative Tissue.** At the start of each of your turns, if you have at least 1 hit point and no more than half your hit point maximum, you regain hit points equal to your proficiency bonus.
- **Catalyst.** Your Burst Surges use d8s for their Surge dice, and your Mend lets the target spend one extra Hit Die.
- **Spore Cloud.** As an action, you exhale spores: a 15-ft-radius sphere centred on you is heavily obscured for 1 minute (it moves with you; you can see through it). Once you do this, you can't again until you finish a short or long rest. **Push:** do it again without the rest.
- **Purge.** As a bonus action, lower your Flux by an amount up to your proficiency bonus; you take 1d6 poison damage per point lowered (ignoring resistance). Once per short or long rest.

Apex *(prerequisites: 15th level, Glands primary, Spit and four other Glands Mutations)*

- **Living Pharmacy.** When you use Regeneration, you can affect every creature of your choice within 15 ft of the target, rolling once. Your Mend Surges cost no Flux the first time each turn. **Push:** Regeneration also grants each creature temporary hit points equal to your Mutant level.

Mind

Root: Uplink. Your brain broadcasts. You can communicate telepathically with any creature you can see within 60 ft that knows a language (Chrome: through a radio carrier; it can be intercepted). *Unlocks Dread and Link.*

Tier I *(prerequisite: Uplink)*

- **Intrude.** As an action, read the surface thoughts of a creature you can see within 30 ft (Wisdom save against your Surge save DC; on a success it knows you tried), or seize control of a simple device such as a lock, camera or drone for 1 minute.
- **Iron Will.** You have advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, and allies within 10 ft of you gain +1 to those saves.
- **Commanding Voice.** You can take the Help action as a bonus action, and you can Help an ally within 30 ft instead of 5.
- **Read the Room.** You gain proficiency in Insight (or expertise if you have it). Once per short rest, you can ask the GM what a creature you're talking to wants most or fears most, and get a truthful one-sentence answer.

Tier II *(prerequisites: 6th level, Uplink and two other Mind Mutations)*

- **Puppet. Push:** as an action, a creature you can see within 60 ft must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or use its reaction to move up to half its speed in a direction you choose or make one melee attack against a creature you choose.
- **Precognition. Push:** when you or an ally within 30 ft makes a d20 roll, use your reaction to grant advantage (before the roll) or impose disadvantage on an attack against you or that ally.
- **Glamour.** You can cast *disguise self* at will, without components. **Push:** cast *invisibility* on yourself (no slot, no components), once per long rest.
- **Dampener.** You have resistance to psychic damage, and you can't be charmed or frightened while you're conscious.

Apex *(prerequisites: 15th level, Mind primary, Uplink and four other Mind Mutations)*

- **Hive Mind.** Your telepathy reaches 1 mile and links all willing allies. Once per round, when an ally you can see within 60 ft makes an attack roll, ability check or saving throw, you can add your Surge ability modifier to it (no action). **Push:** do it a second time in the same round.

Body

Open to every Mutant; no Root. Each counts as one Mutation.

- **Extra Arm.** A third arm. You can hold an extra item, draw or stow two items when you would draw or stow one, and once per turn when you hit with a melee attack, **Push:** grapple the target as part of the hit.
- **Grapnel.** A tongue, tendril or cable. As a bonus action, pull yourself up to 30 ft toward a surface you can see, or pull a Small or smaller object to you.
- **Spring Legs.** Your jump distances are tripled, you take half damage from falling, and standing up from prone costs only 5 ft of movement.
- **Lash Tail.** Your reach for opportunity attacks is 10 ft, and you can make an opportunity attack when a creature enters your reach.
- **Gills.** You can breathe air and water and gain a swimming speed equal to your walking speed.
- **Chameleon Skin.** You can attempt to hide when you're only lightly obscured, and you have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks while you move no more than half your speed.
- **Crusher Grip** *(6th level)*. Your natural weapons deal 1d10 damage (1d12 from 11th level), and a creature you have grappled takes your Strength modifier in bludgeoning damage at the start of each of its turns.
- **Pounce** *(6th level)*. If you move at least 15 ft straight toward a creature and then hit it with a melee attack on the same turn, it must succeed on a Strength save against your Surge save DC or be knocked prone.
- **Many Hands** *(6th level, Extra Arm)*. You can grapple two creatures at once, and you have advantage on grapple checks.
- **Exoskeleton** *(10th level)*. You gain resistance to one of bludgeoning, piercing or slashing damage (choose when you take this Mutation).

Mutant Forms

Your Form is the shape the Mutagen is pushing you toward. Each Form names a **primary Mutation tree** (its Root is free) and, for some, a different Surge ability. Each also has a **Looks** table: your body at each stage, Bio and Chrome.

Form	Surge ability	Primary tree	Role	In one line
Juggernaut	Constitution	Hide	Defender	*"I don't move. You do."*
Skitter	Constitution	Wiring	Striker, skirmisher	*"You blinked. I was already there."*
Oracle	Wisdom	Senses	Ranged striker, scout	*"I saw you coming. Three days ago."*
Alembic	Intelligence	Glands	Healer, controller	*"Hold still. This will either cure you or kill it."*
Siren	Charisma	Mind	Leader, face, controller	*"Everybody look at me."*

Juggernaut

The Mutagen decided you should be unkillable and started stacking. Juggernauts hold doorways, carry the wounded and end arguments by standing in them.

Juggernaut Looks

Stage	Name	Bio	Chrome
Base (1st)	**Juggernaut**	Thick neck, heavy brow, knuckles armoured with horn. Your skin has the give of a car tyre.	Subdermal plates you can feel through your shirt; a spine brace that whines when you stand.
Evolution I (6th)	**Rampart**	You grow a foot in a night. Your back splits into overlapping bone slabs; your forearms swell into shields.	Bulkhead plates bolt over shoulders and chest; your joints are hydraulic now, and they hiss.
Evolution II (14th)	**Colossus**	Nine feet of keratin and scar tissue. Horns, a domed skull, a heartbeat people feel through the floor.	A walking bunker: riveted armour, a face behind a visor slit, treads of steel on your soles.
Final (20th)	**Citadel**	Stone-hard ridges, moss in the cracks, small things nesting in you. You are a place.	Siren lights, warning stencils, a hatch in your chest. Ostrander would classify you as infrastructure.

Juggernaut Features

Mutant Level	Feature
1st	Hide Root (Plating), Bodyguard
3rd	Challenge
6th	Siege Hide (Evolution I)
10th	Living Bulwark
14th	Fortress (Evolution II)

Primary Tree: Hide. You gain the Plating Root for free.

Bodyguard *(1st level)*. When a creature you can see hits a target other than you within 5 ft of you with an attack, you can use your reaction to reduce the damage the target takes by **1d10 + your proficiency bonus** (minimum 0). You can do this even while holding a weapon or shield.

Challenge *(3rd level)*. As a bonus action, choose a creature within 30 ft that can see or hear you. It must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or have disadvantage on attack rolls against targets other than you until the end of your next turn. Whether it succeeds or not, your next melee hit against it before then deals an extra Surge die of damage (no Flux). You can use Challenge a number of times equal to your Surge ability modifier (minimum 1), and you regain all uses when you finish a short or long rest.

Siege Hide *(6th level, Evolution I)*. You become **Large** (you can return to your old size for a day by concentrating for a minute). Your Plating bonus becomes **+2**, your reach with natural weapons increases by 5 ft, and you have advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws. You can't be shoved or knocked prone against your will.

Living Bulwark *(10th level)*. Allies within 5 ft of you gain +1 AC (this doesn't stack with the Living Wall Mutation). When you use Bodyguard, you can take all of the triggering damage yourself instead of reducing it.

Fortress *(14th level, Evolution II)*. When an ally within 10 ft of you takes damage from an effect that affects an area, it takes only half that damage (or none, if it already takes half). Once per round, when an ally you can see within 30 ft would drop to 0 hit points, you can take the damage instead (no action; it can't be reduced except by your resistances).

Finale (Final Form). *Citadel:* while you're transformed, allies within 10 ft of you have resistance to all damage, and creatures you choose can't willingly move out of your reach.

Skitter

The Mutagen took your nerves and set them on fire. Skitters are the fastest thing in any room: clever with their hands, wiry and impossible to pin down.

Skitter Looks

Stage	Name	Bio	Chrome
Base (1st)	**Skitter**	Long limbs, twitchy hands, pupils that never settle; you're warm to the touch.	Reflex jacks at the base of the skull; fingertips with steel contacts that spark when you're nervous.
Evolution I (6th)	**Mantis**	Your forearms fold into barbed hooks; your knees bend backwards; you smell like ozone.	Synthetic muscle cables under translucent skin, and a capacitor hump between your shoulders.
Evolution II (14th)	**Wraith**	Glassy wing-cases that hum, faceted eyes, lightning crawling along your veins.	You blur when you move; a plasma coil glows through your ribs; you leave scorch-prints.
Final (20th)	**Livewire**	Barely solid: a figure of arcs and chitin that's always slightly somewhere else.	A human-shaped storm in a chrome cage, held together by a magnetic field.

Skitter Features

Mutant Level	Feature
1st	Wiring Root (Quickened), Hair-Trigger Nerves
3rd	Reflex Spike
6th	Mantis Reflex (Evolution I)
10th	Slip Through
14th	Lightning Step (Evolution II)

Primary Tree: Wiring. You gain the Quickened Root for free.

Hair-Trigger Nerves *(1st level)*. Your natural weapons are mantis blades: their damage die is **1d10** (it doesn't increase at 11th level). You have advantage on initiative rolls. While you aren't wearing medium or heavy armor or using a shield, your AC equals 10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Constitution modifier.

Reflex Spike *(3rd level)*. When a creature misses you with a melee attack, you can use your reaction to make one melee weapon attack against it. If it hits, you can Unleash a Strike Surge through it even if you've already Unleashed one this turn. You can use this a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, regaining all uses when you finish a long rest.

Mantis Reflex *(6th level, Evolution I)*. You gain **Evasion**: when an effect lets you make a Dexterity save for half damage, you take no damage on a success and half on a failure. Additionally, you get a second reaction each round, which you can use only for Reflex Spike or an opportunity attack.

Slip Through *(10th level)*. You don't provoke opportunity attacks, and difficult terrain doesn't cost you extra movement. When you take the Dash action, you can make one weapon attack as part of it.

Lightning Step *(14th level, Evolution II)*. Your speed increases by another 10 ft. Once on each of your turns when you Unleash a Surge, you can teleport up to 30 ft to an unoccupied space you can see, before or after its effect. When you finish a short rest, you regain one expended use of Reflex Spike.

Finale (Final Form). *Afterburn:* while you're transformed, you can take one additional action on each of your turns (Attack, Dash, Disengage or Use an Object only).

Oracle

The Mutagen opened your eyes, then gave you more of them. Oracles see what's coming: snipers, scouts and the friend who tells you which door is wrong.

Oracle Looks

Stage	Name	Bio	Chrome
Base (1st)	**Oracle**	Pale, still, unsettling eyes with too much iris; you hear heartbeats through walls.	A monocle lens grafted to the socket; tiny antennae behind the ears.
Evolution I (6th)	**Argus**	A third eye opens on your brow; small eyes bead along your collarbones and blink out of time.	A ring of lenses around your head like a crown; your voice comes with a faint radio hiss.
Evolution II (14th)	**Seraph**	Wing-like membranes covered in eyes unfold from your back; you float a hand's width off the floor.	Six optic arms fan out from your spine; holographic targeting halos hang around you.
Final (20th)	**Panopticon**	A tall white shape of lids and lashes; when you look at someone, they feel *seen*.	A tower of lenses and dishes; every camera in the district turns toward you.

Oracle Features

Mutant Level	Feature
1st	Senses Root (Keen), Oracle Sight, Target Lock
3rd	Analyst
6th	Foresight (Evolution I)
10th	Weak Spot
14th	Thousand Eyes (Evolution II)

Primary Tree: Senses. You gain the Keen Root for free. Your Surge ability is **Wisdom**.

Oracle Sight *(1st level)*. You can use Wisdom instead of Strength or Dexterity for the attack and damage rolls of your natural weapons and of ranged weapons with which you're proficient.

Target Lock *(1st level)*. As a bonus action, or as part of hitting a creature with an attack, raise your Flux by 1 and mark a creature you can see within 120 ft for 1 minute (concentration, as if concentrating on a spell). Once per turn when you hit it with an attack, it takes an

extra **1d6** damage of the weapon's or Surge's type, and you always know its location while it's within 120 ft. If it drops to 0 hit points, you can move the mark to a new creature as a bonus action without raising your Flux. You count as having the Target Lock Mutation.

Analyst *(3rd level)*. When you Target Lock a creature, you also learn its AC, its current hit points and its damage resistances, immunities and vulnerabilities. You gain proficiency in Insight and Investigation, or expertise in one if you already have it.

Foresight *(6th level, Evolution I)*. When you roll initiative, roll a d20 and record the result: your **Omen**. Once before the combat ends, you can replace any attack roll, ability check or saving throw made by you or a creature you can see with your Omen (choose before the roll). An unused Omen is lost when combat ends.

Weak Spot *(10th level)*. Your attacks against your Target Locked creature score a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20 and ignore its resistance to their damage.

Thousand Eyes *(14th level, Evolution II)*. You gain blindsight out to 30 ft and can't be surprised. You can Target Lock up to three creatures at once (one concentration), and Foresight gives you **two** Omens.

Finale (Final Form). *Prophecy:* while you're transformed, you roll three Omens when you transform, and each of your attacks against a Target Locked creature is a critical hit if it hits.

Alembic

The Mutagen made you a chemistry set. Alembics brew medicine in their glands, acid in their spit and miracles in their blood. They're the reason the crew comes home.

Alembic Looks

Stage	Name	Bio	Chrome
Base (1st)	**Alembic**	Glands swelling at the throat and wrists; you sweat something sweet-smelling and faintly green.	Injector ports along your forearms, and a hip-mounted reservoir with a gauge.
Evolution I (6th)	**Still**	Translucent sacs bloom across your back, glowing with what you're brewing; your breath fogs.	Coiled tubing and glass vials under a ribcage of chrome; you gurgle when you walk.
Evolution II (14th)	**Bloomheart**	Spore-fronds and flower-like vents open along your spine; insects follow you.	A walking refinery: pressurised tanks, nozzle arrays, a warning placard that reads FLAMMABLE.
Final (20th)	**Wellspring**	A living garden: roots in the floor where you stand, fruit that heals, pollen that kills.	A mobile clinic: hissing pipes, a dozen spigots, steam that smells like hospitals.

Alembic Features

Mutant Level	Feature
1st	Glands Root (Spit), Field Medic, Clinical Precision
3rd	Stim Gland
6th	Transmute (Evolution I)
10th	Miasma
14th	Panacea (Evolution II)

Primary Tree: Glands. You gain the Spit Root for free. Your Surge ability is **Intelligence**.

Clinical Precision *(1st level)*. You gain proficiency with the herbalism kit and the poisoner's kit, and you can use Intelligence instead of Strength or Dexterity for the attack and damage rolls of your natural weapons and Spit.

Field Medic *(1st level)*. Your Regeneration can reach a creature you can see within **30 ft** (a dart, a spray, a lob of gel), and its healing dice are **d10s** instead of d8s. You can stabilise a dying creature within 30 ft as a bonus action.

Stim Gland *(3rd level)*. When you use Regeneration, the creature also gains temporary hit points equal to your Intelligence modifier, and it can end one of these conditions on itself instead of you choosing poisoned: blinded, deafened or frightened.

Transmute *(6th level, Evolution I)*. Your Mend Surges restore extra hit points equal to your proficiency bonus, and your Regeneration can end the paralyzed condition. When you Unleash a Toxin Surge, you can apply the Corrode rider as well (and vice versa).

Miasma *(10th level)*. Your poison and acid damage ignores resistance, and treats immunity to poison damage as resistance. Creatures poisoned by you also have disadvantage on Constitution saves.

Panacea *(14th level, Evolution II)*. As an action, you release a cloud of healing compounds: up to six creatures of your choice within 30 ft each regain hit points equal to **5d8 + your Intelligence modifier** and is cured of one disease and any number of these conditions: blinded, deafened, paralyzed, poisoned, stunned. Once you use Panacea, you can't again until you finish a long rest.

Finale (Final Form). *Elixir of Life:* while you're transformed, at the start of each of your turns you and each ally within 30 ft regain hit points equal to your Intelligence modifier, and an ally who drops to 0 hit points within 30 ft of you drops to 1 instead (once per ally).

Siren

The Mutagen gave you a voice that goes in through the ears and keeps going. Sirens talk, sing and scream: leaders, liars and the most frightening thing on any battlefield that isn't on fire.

Siren Looks

Stage	Name	Bio	Chrome
Base (1st)	**Siren**	Striking face, a voice with a second note under it, a scent people remember.	Voice modulator at the throat; LED tattoos that pulse when you talk.
Evolution I (6th)	**Diva**	Iridescent skin, a frill of feathers or fins at the neck; your voice harmonises with itself.	Speaker grilles bloom along your collarbones; your face projects a light-show halo.
Evolution II (14th)	**Choir**	A crown of soft horns; a dozen mouths open along your arms and sing in chorus.	An antenna crown and a cape of fibre-optic cable; you broadcast on every frequency.
Final (20th)	**Crowned**	Too beautiful to look at directly; people weep, kneel or flee.	A living billboard and a broadcast tower; your face is on every screen, saying *your* name.

Siren Features

Mutant Level	Feature
1st	Mind Root (Uplink), Voice of the Hive
3rd	Command Signal
6th	Siren Song (Evolution I)
10th	Psychic Scream
14th	Crown of Will (Evolution II)

Primary Tree: Mind. You gain the Uplink Root for free. Your Surge ability is **Charisma**.

Voice of the Hive *(1st level)*. You gain proficiency in one of Deception, Intimidation, Performance or Persuasion, and you can use Charisma instead of Strength or Dexterity for the attack and damage rolls of your natural weapons. As a bonus action, or as part of the action or bonus action you use to Unleash a Surge, you can give one creature other than you within 60 ft that can hear you a **Command die**, a d6: once within the next 10 minutes, it can roll the die and add it to an attack roll, ability check or saving throw. You can do this a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier (minimum 1) per long rest, regaining all uses on a short rest from 6th level. The die becomes a d8 at 6th level, a d10 at 10th and a d12 at 14th.

Command Signal *(3rd level)*. When you Unleash a Surge, you can also let one ally who can hear you use its reaction to move up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks. Allies who hear your Uplink telepathy gain a +1 bonus to initiative while you're conscious.

Siren Song *(6th level, Evolution I)*. As a bonus action, you sing: each creature of your choice within 30 ft that can hear you must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or be **charmed** by you until the end of your next turn; a charmed creature can only target you with attacks (it can still attack you) and has disadvantage doing so. You can do this a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus per long rest.

Psychic Scream *(10th level)*. As an action, each creature of your choice within 30 ft that can hear you must make an Intelligence save against your Surge save DC. On a failure it takes psychic damage equal to **twice your Surge dice** (roll them twice) and is frightened of you until the end of its next turn; on a success it takes half damage. Once you use this, you can't again until you finish a short or long rest.

Crown of Will *(14th level, Evolution II)*. As an action, one creature you can see within 60 ft must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or be charmed by you for 1 minute (concentration). While charmed, it obeys your telepathic commands as *dominate monster*. It repeats the save each time it takes damage. Once you use this, you can't again until you finish a long rest.

Finale (Final Form). *Chorus:* while you're transformed, each enemy that starts its turn within 30 ft of you must succeed on a Wisdom save against your Surge save DC or be frightened of you until the start of its next turn, and allies within 30 ft add your Command die to every attack roll (no use expended).

Overload Tables

Roll a d12 when you Overload: **Bloom** if you're Bio, **Glitch** if you're Chrome, your choice if you're Splice. Effects that last "until the end of your next turn" start when you roll. Damage uses your proficiency bonus (PB) as the number of dice; saves use your Surge save DC.

Bloom (Bio)

d12	Bloom
1	**Scar.** A permanent, uncontrolled mutation. Roll on the Scar table.
2	**Seizure.** You fall prone and can't take reactions until the end of your next turn.
3	**Ravenous.** You have disadvantage on ability checks until you eat a ration.
4	**Overgrowth.** Your speed is halved until you finish a short or long rest.
5	**Red Mist.** On your next turn, you must use your action to make a melee attack against the nearest creature, friend or foe (moving to reach one if needed).
6	**Fever.** You're poisoned until the end of your next turn.
7	**Molt.** Your AC drops by 1 until you finish a short or long rest, but you regain PB d8 hit points now.
8	**Twitch.** Roll your Sequence die: that Surge becomes Primed (an empty slot does nothing).
9	**Adrenal Flood.** You gain temporary hit points equal to twice your Mutant level, but you have disadvantage on attack rolls until the end of your next turn.
10	**Cocoon.** You're restrained until the end of your next turn, but you have resistance to all damage until then.
11	**Blossom.** A beautiful permanent change: gain proficiency in one skill it explains (*Bioluminescent*: Performance; *Smells Like Rain*: Persuasion; *Tiger Stripes*: Stealth…). If you've had this result three times, treat it as Flowering instead.
12	**Flowering.** One Surge becomes Amped for this combat, and you gain inspiration.

Glitch (Chrome)

d12	Glitch
1	**Fault.** A permanent malfunction. Roll on the Fault table.
2	**Hard Reboot.** You can't take an action on your next turn (you can still move and take a bonus action).
3	**Short.** You take another PB d6 lightning damage (this can't drop you below 1 hit point).
4	**Joint Lock.** Your speed is 0 until the end of your next turn.
5	**Targeting Error.** Your next attack targets a random creature within range, friend or foe (the GM rolls).
6	**Blackout.** You're blinded until the end of your next turn.
7	**Heat Vent.** Each other creature within 10 ft of you makes a Dexterity save, taking PB d6 fire damage on a failure or half on a success.
8	**Log Dump.** You learn the AC, current hit points, resistances and immunities of one creature you can see.
9	**Safe Mode.** You gain +1 AC, but your Surges cost 1 extra Flux, until the combat ends.
10	**Overclock Spike.** You can take one additional action on your next turn; afterward you can't take reactions until the start of your following turn.
11	**Patch Applied.** Remove one Fault; if you have none, your Flux Limit increases by 1 permanently (once ever; afterward treat as Root Access).
12	**Root Access.** Choose the results of your next Prime or Churn roll instead of rolling, and gain inspiration.

Scars and Faults

Scars and Faults are permanent until removed. A *greater restoration* or *remove curse*, a GRAFT clinic (500 gp) or a **Patch Applied** result removes one. A creature can have at most three; further results are treated as a 12.

d6	Scar (Bio)	Fault (Chrome)
1	**Weeping Pores.** You leave a trail; disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks against creatures that track by smell.	**Tick.** Your chrome clicks; disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks against creatures that rely on hearing.
2	**Wrong Face.** Disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks with non-Mutants, advantage on Charisma (Intimidation) checks against them.	**Static Voice.** As Wrong Face, through a speaker grille.
3	**Hollow Bones.** Your hit point maximum is reduced by your Mutant level; your speed increases by 5 ft.	**Drained Cell.** Your Flux Limit is reduced by 1; you gain +1 AC.
4	**Second Mouth.** It whispers. Once per session, the GM tells you something true you'd rather not know.	**Ghost Process.** Once per session, the GM decides how you use one reaction.
5	**Brittle Shell.** Your AC drops by 1, but you regain 1 hit point at the start of each of your turns while you have at least 1 hit point and are below half your maximum.	**Sticky Relay.** The highest slot of your Sequence is always empty.
6	**Hunger for Change.** Your Flux starts each combat at 1, but your first Surge each combat is Amped.	**Feedback Loop.** As Hunger for Change.

Options: Background, Feats and Gear



Mutagen is set in **Halcyon**, a coastal city whose reactor district flooded and leaked the Mutagen into the water. **G.R.A.F.T.** (Genetic Response And Field Tactics) won the cleanup contract and licenses Mutants as freelancers. **Ostrander**, the security firm that ran the Lockdown camps, hunts unlicensed Mutants with antimutagen weapons. The **Children of the Bloom** worship the Mutagen and want everyone to drink. You can use the Mutant in any 5e world instead: the Mutagen can be a wizard's failed elixir, a meteor's dust or an aberrant god's blood.

Background: GRAFT Freelancer

You signed a waiver you didn't read, took a number and walked into the Spill. GRAFT pays per job and per Sample.

- **Skill Proficiencies:** Survival, and one of Athletics, Investigation or Medicine
- **Tool Proficiencies:** Thieves' tools or tinker's tools
- **Languages:** One of your choice
- **Equipment:** A GRAFT licence card, a gas mask, a scanner, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 15 gp

Feature: Contractor's Licence. GRAFT field offices give you a cot, a hot meal and basic repairs for free, and they'll buy Samples (see Gear) at fair prices. Licensed checkpoint guards let you through the Lockdown cordon without questions, though Ostrander patrols won't.

Suggested Characteristics. Use the Soldier or Folk Hero tables from the SRD, or roll below.

d6	Why you took the job
1	Your family is still somewhere inside the cordon.
2	GRAFT pays for the treatments that keep you stable.
3	You want to know what the Mutagen is doing to you.
4	Ostrander would have put you in a camp otherwise.
5	The money. Honestly, the money.
6	The Bloom spoke to you once. You're trying to forget what it said.

Feats

These feats suit any class, but describe the Mutagen working on a non-Mutant (or a Mutant leaning further in).

Mutagenic Initiate. *Prerequisite: Constitution 13 or higher.* The Mutagen has started on you.

- You learn one Surge built from a base Shape and a base Effect. You have a Flux Limit of 1 and use the Surge rules as a Mutant (Surge dice 1d6, 2d6 at 5th character level, 3d6 at 11th, 4d6 at 17th; Constitution is your Surge ability). You don't Prime; your Flux resets on a short or long rest. If you are a Mutant, instead your Flux Limit increases by 1 and you learn one extra Surge.
- You can use Regeneration (1d8 + your Constitution modifier) once per long rest.

Chrome Graft. You install one implant. Choose a Mutation tree: you gain its Root and one of its Tier I Mutations. A non-Mutant doesn't gain the Root's Surge parts and uses Constitution for any save DC (8 + proficiency bonus + Constitution modifier). Increase one ability score of your choice by 1.

Hardened Survivor. *Prerequisite: Mutant.* Increase your Constitution by 1. When you Overload, you take no damage, and when you roll a Scar or Fault you can reroll once.

Living Weapon. *Prerequisite: Mutant.* Increase your Strength or Dexterity by 1. Your natural weapon damage die increases by one size (d8 to d10, d10 to d12), and once per turn when you hit with one you can grapple or shove the target as part of the hit.

Field Surgeon. Increase your Intelligence or Wisdom by 1. When you use Regeneration, a healer's kit, or a spell that restores hit points to a creature, it regains extra hit points equal to your proficiency bonus. You can stabilise a creature as a bonus action.

Gear

Prices are in gold pieces for any 5e world; in Halcyon read "gp" as "Scrip".

Mutagen Gear

Item	Cost	Weight	Description
GRAFT stim	25 gp	—	Action: drink or inject to regain 1d4 + 1 hit points (2d4 + 2 for a Mutant, whose body takes it better).
Damper	50 gp	—	Bonus action: lower your Flux by 2. Only once per short rest.
Antimutagen dart	50 gp	—	Thrown (20/60). On a hit, a Mutant loses one Primed Surge (its choice); other creatures take 1d4 poison damage.
Gas mask	20 gp	1 lb.	Advantage on saves against inhaled poisons, gases and spores.
Scanner	50 gp	2 lb.	Detects heat, motion and the Mutagen within 60 ft (through 1 ft of stone or a thin sheet of metal).
Hack deck	50 gp	2 lb.	Proficiency-like +2 to checks to bypass electronic locks and devices; required to do so without the Mind tree.
Breach kit	30 gp	5 lb.	Advantage on checks to force doors and locks.
Clinic visit	500 gp	—	Removes one Scar or Fault.
Sample splice	100 gp	—	Install a harvested Sample (see below).

Weapons of Halcyon. Use SRD weapons for scavenged gear: a rebar club is a mace, a pipe-axe a greataxe, a chainsaw a greatsword (loud), a pistol a hand crossbow (piercing, 30/120, reload 6), a rifle a heavy

crossbow (100/400), a shotgun a heavy crossbow with range 30/90 that doesn't impose disadvantage when you fire it within 5 ft of a hostile creature. If your table uses the SRD's firearms, use those instead.

Weapon Mods (one per weapon, 100 gp each; a mod makes the weapon count as magical for overcoming resistance)

Mod	Effect
Keen Edge / Hollow-point	The weapon scores a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20 (doesn't stack with other crit-range features; use the best).
Shock Coil	The weapon's damage becomes lightning; on a critical hit the target can't take reactions until the start of its next turn.
Incendiary	The damage becomes fire; on a critical hit the target takes 1d6 fire damage at the start of its next turn.
Venom Channel	The damage becomes poison; on a critical hit the target is poisoned until the end of its next turn.
Weighted	On a critical hit the target is knocked prone (Huge or smaller).
Suppressor	Attacking with the weapon doesn't reveal your position.
Smart-Link	+1 to attack rolls with the weapon. Chrome: needs 5 gp of upkeep a week.

Samples. Some Mutagen creatures (marked *Sample* in the Bestiary) leave a harvestable gland, crystal or chip. With a Sample splice, a Mutant can learn the Sample's Surge (a Shape + Effect it lists, even one whose Root they lack) as an extra Surge known. A Mutant can carry one Sample Surge at a time.

Bestiary

Selected threats from *Mutagen*'s roster, rebuilt as 5e stat blocks. Challenge ratings were computed with the DMG's *Creating a Monster* method (effective hit points and AC for defense; damage per round over three rounds and attack bonus or save DC for offense) by `5e/tools/bestiary.py`, which re-checks them on every build. Creatures marked *Sample* leave a harvestable Surge (Options chapter).



Creature	CR	Stage	Role
Bloomhound	1/2	Base	Pack hunter
Scrapjack Picker	1/2	Base	Skirmisher
Spill Rats	1/2	Base	Swarm
Turret Drone	1/2	Base	Artillery
Ward Tough	1/2	Base	Soldier
Ostrander Cleaner	1	Base	Soldier
Sporecaller	1	Base	Healer, leader
Cleaner Hound	2	Evolution I	Pack hunter
Damper Drone	2	Evolution I	Controller
Drain Beast	3	Base	Brute
Boiler Hulk	4	Base	Brute
Bloom Knight	5	Evolution I	Soldier
The Brood Matriarch	5	Boss	Boss
Glasshide	8	Evolution I	Brute
Hunter-Killer Unit	8	Evolution I	Assassin
Warden Krell	10	Boss	Boss
The Drowned Choir	11	Evolution II	Controller
Feral Evolved	12	Evolution II	Elite
Reactor Wraith	12	Evolution II	Artillery, brute
Patient Zero	23	Boss	Boss (final)

Base Stage (levels 1–5)

Spill Rats

Medium swarm of Tiny beasts, unaligned

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 31 (7d8)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	2 (-4)	12 (+1)	4 (-3)

Skills Perception +3

Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, slashing

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, prone, restrained, stunned

Senses darkvision 30 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages —

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature's space and vice versa, and it can move through any opening large enough for a Tiny rat. It can't regain hit points or gain temporary hit points.

Mutagenic. A creature that starts its turn in the swarm's space must succeed on a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or gain 1 Flux (a Mutant) or become poisoned until the start of its next turn (anyone else).

Actions

Bites. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 0 ft., one target in the swarm's space. *Hit:* 7 (2d6) piercing damage plus 2 (1d4) poison damage, or 3 (1d6) piercing damage plus 2 (1d4) poison damage if the swarm has half of its hit points or fewer.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Strike + Toxin** Surge (see Gear).

Hairless, glowing, wrong number of legs. They pour out of pipes in fours or more and all bite the same freelancer.

Scrapjack Picker

Medium humanoid (Mutant), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 14 (scrap armor)

Hit Points 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	9 (-1)

Skills Perception +2, Sleight of Hand +4, Stealth +4

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Scrapjack cant

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Pack Tactics. The picker has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the picker's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Magnet Gloves. The picker has advantage on checks to disarm a creature or steal an item, and on attacks against a creature wearing metal armor.

Actions

Hook-Blade. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage.

Rivet Gun. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Scavengers in welded scrap armour. They gang up on whoever has visible chrome and scatter when two are down.

Ward Tough

Medium humanoid (any), any alignment

Armor Class 12 (leather armor)
Hit Points 39 (6d8 + 12)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	9 (-1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Athletics +4, Intimidation +2
Senses passive Perception 10
Languages Common
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Cowardly. While the tough has half of its hit points or fewer, it surrenders at the start of its turn on a d6 roll of 4–6 if it can see an enemy.

Actions

Multiattack. The tough makes two attacks with its pipe or pistol.

Pipe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Pistol. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage.

Waders, a rebar club and a family to feed. He wants to be paid, not killed.

Bloomhound

Medium monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)
Hit Points 32 (5d8 + 10)
Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)

Skills Perception +3
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages —
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Pack Tactics. The bloomhound has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of its allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Frenzy. The bloomhound deals an extra 2 damage with its attacks for each bloomhound that has died within 60 feet of it this combat (maximum +4).

Actions

Split-Jaw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until the grapple ends, the bloomhound can't bite another target.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Strike + Snare** Surge (see Gear).

A dog that opens like a flower. One holds, the rest bite.

Turret Drone

Small construct, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (plating)
Hit Points 27 (6d6 + 6)
Speed 0 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	1 (-5)

Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11
Languages —
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Explosive. When the drone drops to 0 hit points, it explodes. Each creature within 10 feet of it must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw, taking 7 (2d6) fire damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

Actions

Flechette Spray. The drone fires into a 10-foot-radius sphere centred on a point it can see within 90 feet. Each creature in it must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw, taking 9 (2d8) piercing damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

A coffee-can drone with a shotgun. It hovers out of reach and fires into clusters.

Ostrander Cleaner

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class 16 (chain shirt, riot shield)
Hit Points 45 (7d8 + 14)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Con +4
Skills Perception +3
Damage Resistances poison
Senses passive Perception 13
Languages Common
Challenge 1 (200 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Shield Wall. The cleaner gains +1 AC for each other cleaner within 5 feet of it (maximum +2).

Hazmat Suit. The cleaner has advantage on saving throws against inhaled poisons, gases and the Mutagenic trait.

Actions

Purge Rifle. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 120/400 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 3) piercing damage. If the target is a Mutant, it loses one Primed Surge (its choice).

Foam Sprayer (Recharge 5–6). The cleaner sprays a 15-foot cone. Each creature in it must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, it takes 10 (3d6) cold damage and is restrained until the end of its next turn; on a success, it takes half as much damage and isn't restrained.

Hazmat suit, antimutagen rifle, no face. They advance in pairs behind riot shields and foam anyone mid-Surge.

Sporecaller

Medium humanoid (Mutant), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 12

Hit Points 71 (11d8 + 22)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Wis +5
Skills Medicine +4, Religion +2
Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities poisoned
Senses passive Perception 12
Languages Common
Challenge 1 (200 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Hymn of the Bloom. Allies of the sporecaller within 30 feet of it deal an extra 2 (1d4) damage with their weapon attacks while it isn't incapacitated.

Actions

Spore Hymn. Each creature of the sporecaller's choice in a 20-foot-radius sphere centred on a point within 60 feet must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, it takes 7 (2d6) poison damage and is poisoned until the end of its next turn; on a success, it takes half as much damage.

Knit Wounds. One creature the sporecaller can see within 30 feet regains 11 (2d8 + 2) hit points.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Burst + Toxin** Surge (see Gear).

A Bloom priest with a mouth full of flowers. It stays behind its flock, sings and knits their wounds shut.

Drain Beast

Huge monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)
Hit Points 95 (10d12 + 30)
Speed 30 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	2 (-4)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)

Skills Stealth +2
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages —
Challenge 3 (700 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Hold Breath. The beast can hold its breath for 30 minutes.

Regeneration. The beast regains 5 hit points at the start of its turn unless it took acid or fire damage since its last turn.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14). Until the grapple ends, the target is restrained and the beast can't bite another target.

Tail Thrash (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 20 feet of the beast, friend or foe, must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 17 (3d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

A drowned bull crocodile the size of a bus. It thrashes when surrounded and drags one victim under when not.

Boiler Hulk

Large construct, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (riveted plate)
Hit Points 85 (9d10 + 36)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	5 (-3)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)

Damage Immunities fire, poison
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, poisoned
Senses passive Perception 9
Languages understands Common but can't speak
Challenge 4 (1,100 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Heated Body. A creature that touches the hulk or hits it with a melee attack while within 5 feet of it takes 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The hulk makes two Furnace Fist attacks.

Furnace Fist. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage plus 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Steam Vent (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 20 feet of the hulk, friend or foe, must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw, taking 21 (6d6) fire damage on a failure or half as much on a success. The hulk can't use Furnace Fist on its next turn.

A walking furnace bolted onto a press-ganged diver. It wades into the middle of the party and vents.

Evolution I Stage (levels 5–12)

Cleaner Hound

Medium construct, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (plating)
Hit Points 52 (8d8 + 16)
Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	3 (-4)	13 (+1)	1 (-5)

Skills Perception +3
Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages —
Challenge 2 (450 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Pack Tactics. The hound has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of its allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Mutagen Scent. The hound has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks to find Mutants and always knows which creature within 60 feet last Unleashed a Surge.

Actions

Injector Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) piercing damage plus 7 (2d6) poison damage. If the target is a Mutant, it loses one Primed Surge (its choice).

Ostrander's chrome dogs. They run in threes and chase whoever just Surged.

Damper Drone

Medium construct, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (plating)
Hit Points 84 (13d8 + 26)
Speed 0 ft., fly 30 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)	14 (+2)	3 (-4)

Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages —
Challenge 2 (450 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Damper Field. Each Unleash by a Mutant within 60 feet of the drone raises their Flux by 1 more. A spellcaster within 60 feet must succeed on a DC 14 Constitution save to cast a spell of 1st level or higher; on a failure the action is lost but the slot isn't.

Actions

Null Pulse. The drone pulses a 10-foot-radius sphere centred on a point within 60 feet. Each creature in it must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw, taking 18 (4d8) force damage and being unable to take reactions until the start of its next turn on a failure, or half damage on a success.

A floating antimutagen censer. It hangs back over the Ostrander line.

Bloom Knight

Medium plant, lawful neutral

Armor Class 17 (bark plate)
Hit Points 102 (12d8 + 48)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	18 (+4)	9 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws Str +7, Con +7
Damage Resistances poison
Senses tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages Common
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Regrowth. The knight regains 5 hit points at the start of its turn unless it took fire damage since its last turn.

Rooted Stance. The knight can't be moved or knocked prone against its will while it is on soil or plants.

Actions

Multiattack. The knight makes two Thorn Glaive attacks.

Thorn Glaive. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d12 + 4) slashing damage plus 4 (1d8) poison damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned until the end of its next turn.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Strike + Toxin** Surge (see Gear).

A holy warrior grown from a single rosebush. It stands in front of Sporecallers and never retreats.

Glasshide

Huge monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points 147 (14d12 + 56)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
21 (+5)	9 (-1)	19 (+4)	3 (-4)	11 (+0)	6 (-2)

Saving Throws Con +7
Damage Vulnerabilities lightning, thunder
Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages —
Challenge 8 (3,900 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Territorial. If another glasshide is within 120 feet, at the start of its turn roll a d6: on a 1–4, it attacks that glasshide instead of anything else.

Crystal Body. A creature that hits the glasshide with a melee attack while within 5 feet takes 3 (1d6) slashing damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The glasshide makes two Crystal Maul attacks.

Crystal Maul. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) bludgeoning damage. A Large or smaller target must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Shatter Roar (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 20 feet of the glasshide, friend or foe, must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, taking 36 (8d8) thunder damage on a failure or half as much on a success.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Pulse + Quake** Surge (see Gear).

A bear grown into a cathedral of quartz. It charges the loudest thing in the room.

Hunter-Killer Unit

Medium construct, lawful evil

Armor Class 18 (plating)
Hit Points 165 (22d8 + 66)
Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Con +6
Skills Perception +5, Stealth +8
Damage Resistances lightning
Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, poisoned
Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 15
Languages Common
Challenge 8 (3,900 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Hunter Protocol. The unit has advantage on attack rolls against a creature that has half its hit points or fewer.

Evasion. If the unit is subjected to an effect that allows it to make a Dexterity saving throw to take only half damage, it instead takes no damage if it succeeds and half if it fails.

Actions

Multiattack. The unit makes three attacks with its mono-wire or arc pistol, in any combination.

Mono-Wire. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) slashing damage.

Arc Pistol. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, range 60/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d10 + 5) lightning damage, and the target can't take reactions until the start of its next turn.

Reactions

Countermeasure. When a creature within 60 feet Unleashes a Surge or casts a spell, the unit makes one Arc Pistol attack against it.

Ostrander's chrome assassin. It kills the medic first.

Evolution II Stage (Levels 11–20)

Feral Evolved

Large aberration (Mutant), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points 207 (18d10 + 108)
Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	16 (+3)	22 (+6)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Str +10, Con +10
Skills Athletics +10, Perception +6
Damage Resistances acid, fire, poison
Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 16
Languages understands Common
Challenge 12 (8,400 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Regeneration. The evolved regains 10 hit points at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point.

Shift (1/Day). The first time the evolved drops to half its hit points or fewer, it stops at exactly half, ends every condition on itself, and each creature within 30 feet must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened of it for 1 minute (save ends at end of each turn). Its claws deal an extra 9 (2d8) damage for the rest of the fight.

Actions

Multiattack. The evolved makes three Wrong Claws attacks.

Wrong Claws. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (2d12 + 6) slashing damage.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Strike + Kinetic** Surge (see Gear).

A freelancer whose second Evolution went wrong. It remembers your names.

The Drowned Choir

Huge swarm of Medium undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 16
Hit Points 230 (20d12 + 100)
Speed 20 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	20 (+5)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Wis +7, Cha +9
Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, slashing
Damage Immunities poison, psychic
Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, poisoned, prone, restrained
Senses blindsight 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages Common (all at once)
Challenge 11 (7,200 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Swarm. The Choir can occupy another creature's space and vice versa. It can't regain hit points.

Conductor. Allies within 60 feet of the Choir deal an extra 4 (1d8) psychic damage with their attacks.

Actions

Undertow Song. Each creature of the Choir's choice within 30 feet that can hear it must make a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, it takes 33 (6d10) psychic damage and must use its next move to walk toward the nearest deep water or the Choir; on a success, it takes half as much damage.

Drowning Grasp. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 0 ft., one creature in the Choir's space. *Hit:* 22 (4d8 + 4) cold damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 17) and can't breathe.

Fifty drowned voices fused into one. It sings the living toward the water.

Reactor Wraith

Large undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 17
Hit Points 210 (20d10 + 100)
Speed 0 ft., fly 40 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Con +9, Wis +6
Damage Resistances acid, cold, lightning; bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Damage Immunities fire, necrotic, poison, radiant
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, poisoned, prone, restrained
Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages —
Challenge 12 (8,400 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Incorporeal Movement. The wraith can move through creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Radiation. A creature that starts its turn within 10 feet of the wraith takes 7 (2d6) radiant damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The wraith uses Irradiate twice.

Irradiate. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +10 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 27 (5d10) radiant damage, and the target's hit point maximum is reduced by 5 until it finishes a long rest.

Meltdown (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 30 feet of the wraith, friend or foe, must make a DC 18 Constitution saving throw, taking 63 (18d6) fire damage on a failure or half as much on a success. The wraith can't use Meltdown again until it has used Irradiate on a turn.

The ghost of a cooling tower. It hovers into the middle of the fight and goes critical.

Bosses

The Brood Matriarch

Huge monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)
Hit Points 136 (13d12 + 52)
Speed 0 ft. (rooted); 30 ft. after Shift

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	4 (-3)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Con +7, Wis +4
Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities poisoned, prone
Senses tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 11
Languages —
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Legendary Resistance (1/Day). If the Matriarch fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Shift. When the Matriarch first drops to half her hit points or fewer, she tears free of the pipes: she ends every condition on herself, her speed becomes 30 feet, and she can make one Brood-Lash attack against each of two targets with one action.

Actions

Multiattack. The Matriarch makes two Brood-Lash attacks.

Brood-Lash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 14).

Screech (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 30 feet must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw, taking 14 (4d6) psychic damage and becoming frightened until the end of its next turn on a failure, or half damage on a success.

Legendary Actions

The Matriarch can take 2 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. She regains spent legendary actions at the start of her turn.

Lash. The Matriarch makes one Brood-Lash attack.

Birth (Costs 2 Actions). Two **Spill Rats** swarms burst from her body into unoccupied spaces within 15 feet (no more than four at once). They act on her initiative.

Sample: harvesting it (DC 13 Medicine or tinker's tools, 10 minutes) yields a **Wave + Snare** Surge (see Gear).

A womb the size of a truck, rooted into the pipes. She holds the strongest freelancer and Births when the swarms thin out.

Warden Krell

Medium humanoid (human), lawful evil

Armor Class 19 (riot plate, shield)
Hit Points 187 (22d8 + 88)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Str +8, Con +8, Wis +7
Skills Athletics +8, Intimidation +8, Perception +7
Damage Resistances poison
Senses passive Perception 17
Languages Common
Challenge 10 (5,900 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If Krell fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

Leader. Allies within 60 feet of Krell that can hear him deal an extra 3 (1d6) damage with their weapon attacks.

Shift. When Krell first drops to half his hit points or fewer, he ends every condition on himself, gains +1 AC, and his Riot Slam recharges and becomes a 20-foot burst around him.

Actions

Multiattack. Krell makes three Purge Carbine or Shock Baton attacks.

Shock Baton. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage plus 4 (1d8) lightning damage.

Purge Carbine. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, range 120/400 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage. A Mutant hit loses one Primed Surge and gains 1 Flux.

Riot Slam (Recharge 5–6). Krell slams his shield forward in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in it must make a DC 16 Strength saving throw, taking 27 (6d8) thunder damage and falling prone on a failure, or half damage on a success.

Legendary Actions

Krell can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. He regains spent legendary actions at the start of his turn.

Fire. Krell makes one Purge Carbine attack.

Advance. Krell moves up to half his speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Call the Line (Costs 2 Actions). Two **Ostrander Cleaners** arrive from the nearest door or cover (no more than four at once). They act on his initiative.

The Ostrander officer who ran the Lockdown camps. He opens from cover, Purges whoever has the most Primed Surges and calls the Line the moment the party bunches up.

Patient Zero

Huge aberration (Mutant), neutral

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)
Hit Points 348 (24d12 + 192)
Speed 40 ft.; fly 40 ft. after Shift

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
24 (+7)	14 (+2)	26 (+8)	20 (+5)	22 (+6)	24 (+7)

Saving Throws Con +15, Wis +13, Cha +14
Skills Insight +13, Perception +13
Damage Resistances acid, cold, fire, lightning, necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from nonmagical attacks
Damage Immunities poison, psychic

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, poisoned

Senses truesight 120 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages all, telepathy 1 mile

Challenge 23 (50,000 XP) · **Proficiency Bonus** +7

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If Patient Zero fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Regeneration. Patient Zero regains 20 hit points at the start of its turn unless it took radiant damage since its last turn.

Source. Mutants within 60 feet of Patient Zero can't lower their Flux by any means, and their Overloads always roll twice and use the worse result.

Shift. When Patient Zero first drops to half its hit points or fewer, it ends every condition on itself, gains a flying speed of 40 feet, and its Unmaking Touch can target three creatures with one attack roll each instead of one.

Actions

Multiattack. Patient Zero makes three Unmaking Touch attacks.

Unmaking Touch. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +14 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. *Hit:* 29 (4d10 + 7) necrotic damage. A Mutant hit gains 2 Flux; any other creature must succeed on a DC 21 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by the damage taken until it finishes a long rest.

The First Song (Recharge 5–6). Each creature within 60 feet that can hear Patient Zero must make a DC 22 Wisdom saving throw, taking 55 (10d10) psychic damage and becoming frightened for 1 minute on a failure (repeat the save at the end of each of its turns), or half damage on a success.

Legendary Actions

Patient Zero can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. It regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Touch. Patient Zero makes one Unmaking Touch attack.

Speak. One creature that can hear it must succeed on a DC 22 Wisdom saving throw or use its reaction to move up to its speed toward Patient Zero.

Bloom (Costs 2 Actions). Two **Bloom Knights** grow from the floor within 30 feet (no more than four at once). They act on its initiative.

The first person ever to take the Mutagen, still alive in the reactor core. It talks before it fights. Save its Shift for after the party has spent their Final Forms.

Design Notes

From Mutagen to 5e

Mutagen	*Mutagen 5e*
Five Base Forms, no classes	One class, the **Mutant**; the Forms are its subclasses, chosen at 1st level
Six Augment trees (Hide, Limbs, Senses, Glands, Wiring, Mind)	Five **Mutation trees** plus the open **Body** list. Limbs, the tree no Form used as primary, was cannibalised: natural weapons, Extra Attack, grappling and movement went into the class chassis and the Body list, so no Form had to be cut
Grit, Moxie, Nerve, Gumption, Chutzpah	Str/Con, Dex, Wis, Int, Cha. Surge ability: Con (Juggernaut, Skitter), Wis (Oracle), Int (Alembic), Cha (Siren)
Levels 1–10, Rank	Levels 1–20, proficiency bonus; Surge dice 1d8 → 4d8 at the 5/11/17 tier jumps
Evolutions at 4 and 7, Final Form at 10	Evolution I at 6, Evolution II at 14, Final Form at 20
Guard, TN, Dodge/Endure/Resist	AC, save DC, Dexterity/Constitution/Wisdom saves
Dazed, Held, Exposed, Burning, Shaken	No reactions, restrained, "next attack has advantage", fire damage next turn, frightened
Breather / Lockdown	Short rest / long rest
Regenerate (Glands node)	**Regeneration**, a 1st-level class feature for every Mutant
Threat level, BR/MR	Challenge rating (DMG method, checked by `tools/bestiary.py`)

Balance Targets

The class was built to these targets, drawn from the SRD class analysis (research 01) and homebrew conventions (research 02), and checked with `tools/bench.py` (research 05):

- **Damage:** sustained damage over an adventuring day within ±15% of the SRD martial average at levels 1, 3, 5, 11, 17 and 20; a one-round nova no higher than a Paladin's.
- **Healing:** per long rest, more than a Paladin's *Lay on Hands* and less than a Druid or Life Cleric spending every slot on healing; an Alembic may reach a Druid's level.
- **Resources:** a short-rest pool (Flux) that never runs dry at levels 1–4, plus long-rest Regeneration.
- **Structure:** subclass at 1st, a feature at every level, ASIs at 4/8/12/16/19, Extra Attack at 5, one strong and one weak save, a capstone worth reaching.

Balance Check Results

Measured with `tools/bench.py` against the twelve SRD classes (full tables in `research/05_balance_check.md`):

Level	1	3	5	8	11	14	17	20
SRD martial average, Day DPR	8.0	11.3	21.4	24.1	29.6	30.7	34.6	38.6
Mutant (greatsword + Strike), Day DPR	8.7	11.2	23.6	26.5	33.4	33.4	36.8	39.5
Paladin, Day DPR	7.8	10.2	23.1	26.1	36.7	38.1	42.1	43.5
Druid, Day DPR	3.6	6.7	11.9	16.3	18.0	19.8	24.0	25.3

Healing per long rest	L1	L3	L5	L11	L17
Paladin, *Lay on Hands*	5	15	25	55	85
Mutant, Regeneration	18	36	75	147	270
Bard, *Healing Word* (all slots)	11	38	76	198	272
Alembic, Regeneration + Panacea	20	46	95	186	448
Druid, *Cure Wounds* (all slots)	15	62	116	310	438
Life Cleric, *Cure Wounds* (all slots)	21	74	142	370	524

Every Form stays within 0.82–1.15× the martial average's sustained damage, with or without short rests; the Mutant's best single round is below a Paladin's from 2nd level on.

Community Gaps Addressed

Common complaints about 5e classes (sources in `research/06_community_gaps.md`) and the Mutant's answer:

Complaint	Answer
Martials have nothing to do outside combat	**Adaptations** (2nd level) and utility Mutations; Surges work outside combat
Martials can't control groups	Area Surges with riders; Siren Song, Psychic Scream, Crown of Will
Repetitive turns	A new Sequence every fight; Surges built from parts; Churn, Overload and Instinct choices
Bonus-action crowding	Regeneration can replace an attack; Target Lock on a hit; Emergence on initiative; Command dice with a Surge
Dead levels	A feature at every level; ASI levels also add a Mutation
Tables skip short rests	**Settle** halves Flux at each initiative, so the class plays the same with or without short rests
Yo-yo healing	Regeneration gives temporary hit points to a creature that's still standing
Subclass arrives late	Form at 1st level
Random features fizzle or punish	Primed Surges are discounts, never lock-outs; Wild Surges are always good; Instinct and Controlled Overload
Multiple-ability dependence	Oracle, Alembic and Siren attack with their Surge ability
Situational picks are stuck	Swap one Mutation every long rest
Most campaigns end by 10th level	Form features at 1/3/6/10; Evolution I at 6th